

D118

Adult Primary Care for the Advanced Practice Nurse

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A 52-year-old accountant who runs three times a week has two averaged office readings of 134/78. His father had a stroke at 80. What is his blood pressure category?

- A. Stage 2, because of family history.
- B. Stage 1 hypertension.
- C. Elevated.
- D. Normal, since hypertension starts at 140/90.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which averaged reading is classified as elevated blood pressure?

- A. 132/76
- B. 118/78
- C. 126/76
- D. 126/84

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 47-year-old retail manager with no symptoms has an A1C of 6.8% and a fasting glucose of 131 mg/dL on the same visit. She has a new puppy and a busy schedule. What is the correct interpretation?

- A. Needs a third test before any diagnosis.
- B. Type 2 diabetes, confirmed by two abnormal tests.
- C. Stress hyperglycemia from her busy schedule.
- D. Prediabetes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient has an A1C of 6.0% and no symptoms. What does this indicate?

- A. Prediabetes.
- B. Diabetes.
- C. Normal.
- D. Diabetes if fasting glucose is 110.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A 61-year-old with type 2 diabetes and a prior heart attack, who works as a mail carrier, takes metformin. A1C is 7.2%. He prefers morning dosing. Which addition is best supported?

- A. An SGLT2 inhibitor or GLP-1 receptor agonist with proven cardiovascular benefit.
- B. Insulin, since it is always the next step.
- C. A sulfonylurea, since it lowers A1C quickly.
- D. No change, because his A1C is near goal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

An average-risk 46-year-old who works as a firefighter and has never been screened asks about colon cancer screening at his annual visit. His mother had breast cancer. What is the best advice?

- A. Start early because of his mother's breast cancer.
- B. Wait until age 50.
- C. Screening is only needed if symptoms appear.
- D. Begin colorectal cancer screening now.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A healthy 78-year-old with regular prior normal colorectal screening asks if she should keep screening. What is the best approach?

- A. Stop, since screening ends at 50.
- B. Continue screening every year for life.
- C. Restart as if never screened.
- D. Make an individual decision based on her health, prior results, and preferences.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A 58-year-old who smokes, enjoys woodworking, and has a new grandchild says, "I know I should quit, but it's the only thing that helps me relax." What is the best response?

- A. "You need to quit now; smoking will kill you."
- B. "It helps you relax, and you also see reasons to quit. What would quitting mean for you?"
- C. "Everyone can quit if they really try."
- D. "Woodworking could replace smoking."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A 40-year-old office worker who recently moved into a new house has had low back pain for 10 days after lifting boxes. She has no fever, weakness, numbness, or bladder or bowel changes. She asks for an MRI. What is the best plan?

- A. Order an MRI, since lifting injuries always damage discs.
- B. Order bed rest for two weeks.
- C. No imaging now; advise staying active with conservative care and return if red flags appear.
- D. Order an MRI to reassure her.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which finding in a patient with low back pain calls for urgent evaluation?

- A. Pain lasting one week after yard work.
- B. Muscle tenderness beside the spine.
- C. Pain that worsens after sitting at a desk.
- D. New urinary retention with numbness in the saddle area.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11.

A 64-year-old retired nurse who had shingles three years ago and walks daily asks if she needs the shingles vaccine. Her last tetanus booster was 12 years ago. What is the best advice about zoster vaccine?

- A. Give two doses of recombinant zoster vaccine.
- B. One dose is always enough.
- C. No vaccine needed because she already had shingles.
- D. Give only a tetanus booster.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

A 44-year-old nonsmoker who teaches high school chemistry has an LDL of 205 mg/dL. His blood pressure is normal and he plays tennis weekly. What is the best management?

- A. Low-intensity statin.
- B. Calculate 10-year risk first and treat only if above 7.5%.
- C. Start high-intensity statin therapy along with lifestyle changes.
- D. Lifestyle change only, since he is active.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A 52-year-old accountant ~~who runs three times a week~~ has two averaged office readings of 134/78. ~~His father had a stroke at 80.~~ What is his blood pressure category?

Target word: BP category **Decides:** Systolic 130-139.

A	Camouflage	Family history does not change the category.
B	Correct	Systolic 130-139 places him in stage 1 even with diastolic < 80.
C	Confusion set	Elevated is 120-129 systolic.
D	Adjacent category	Uses the older JNC 7 threshold.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Which averaged reading is classified as elevated blood pressure?

Target word: pick the elevated reading **Decides:** 120-129 and < 80.

A	Wrong stem number	Systolic 130-139 is stage 1.
B	Confusion set	Normal.
C	Correct	Systolic 120-129 with diastolic < 80.
D	Inverted operation	A diastolic of 80-89 makes it stage 1.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A 47-year-old retail manager with no symptoms has an A1C of 6.8% and a fasting glucose of 131 mg/dL on the same visit. ~~She has a new puppy and a busy schedule.~~ What is the correct interpretation?

Target word: diagnosis **Decides:** Two different tests both above diabetes cutoffs.

A	Absolute language	Two concordant abnormal results are enough.
B	Correct	A1C $\geq$ 6.5% and fasting $\geq$ 126 together confirm the diagnosis.
C	Camouflage	Life stress does not explain an A1C of 6.8%.
D	Wrong stem number	Both values are above the prediabetes ranges.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

A patient has an A1C of 6.0% and no symptoms. What does this indicate?

Target word: classify A1C **Decides:** 5.7-6.4%.

A	Correct	6.0% falls in the 5.7-6.4% range.
B	Inverted operation	Requires 6.5% or higher.
C	Confusion set	Normal is below 5.7%.
D	Adjacent category	Fasting 110 is also prediabetes.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A 61-year-old with type 2 diabetes and a prior heart attack, ~~who works as a mail carrier~~, takes metformin. A1C is 7.2%. ~~He prefers morning dosing.~~ Which addition is best supported?

Target word: next agent **Decides:** Established ASCVD drives choice.

A	Correct	Guidelines favor these agents with ASCVD regardless of A1C.
B	Absolute language	Insulin is not automatically next.
C	Adjacent category	Chooses by A1C alone and ignores cardiovascular benefit.
D	Dropped element	Drops the comorbidity-based indication.

6. Answer D Concept 4

An average-risk 46-year-old ~~who works as a firefighter~~ and has never been screened asks about colon cancer screening at his annual visit. ~~His mother had breast cancer.~~ What is the best advice?

Target word: screening timing **Decides:** Average risk starts at 45.

A	Camouflage	A family history of breast cancer does not change his colorectal risk level here.
B	Wrong stem number	The older start age.
C	Inverted operation	Screening is for people without symptoms.
D	Correct	USPSTF recommends starting at 45 for average-risk adults.

7. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A healthy 78-year-old with regular prior normal colorectal screening asks if she should keep screening. What is the best approach?

Target word: screening past 75 **Decides:** 76–85 is individualized.

A	Inverted operation	Screening runs through 75.
B	Absolute language	Screening is not routine past 75.
C	Confusion set	Ignores her prior normal results.
D	Correct	USPSTF advises selective screening at 76–85.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A 58-year-old who smokes, ~~enjoys woodworking, and has a new grandchild~~ says, “I know I should quit, but it's the only thing that helps me relax.” What is the best response?

Target word: MI response **Decides:** Reflect ambivalence and draw out his reasons.

A	Inverted operation	Confrontation builds resistance.
B	Correct	Reflects both sides and invites his own reasons.
C	Absolute language	Absolute and dismissive.
D	Camouflage	Jumps to a fix from an unrelated detail.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A 40-year-old office worker ~~who recently moved into a new house~~ has had low back pain for 10 days after lifting boxes. She has no fever, weakness, numbness, or bladder or bowel changes. She asks for an MRI. What is the best plan?

Target word: imaging decision **Decides:** No red flags.

A	Absolute language	Most lifting-related back pain is self-limited.
B	Adjacent category	Bed rest slows recovery.
C	Correct	Imaging is not indicated for acute nonspecific low back pain.
D	Inverted operation	Imaging without red flags adds cost without benefit.

10. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

Which finding in a patient with low back pain calls for urgent evaluation?

Target word: identify a red flag **Decides:** Signs of cauda equina syndrome.

A	Wrong stem number	Short duration without red flags.
B	Adjacent category	A benign exam finding.
C	Confusion set	Common mechanical pattern.
D	Correct	Suggests cauda equina syndrome, an emergency.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A 64-year-old retired nurse who had shingles three years ago ~~and walks daily~~ asks if she needs the shingles vaccine. Her last tetanus booster was 12 years ago. What is the best advice about zoster vaccine?

Target word: zoster vaccine **Decides:** Recommended even after prior shingles.

A	Correct	Prior shingles does not remove the recommendation.
B	Absolute language	The series is two doses.
C	Inverted operation	Prior shingles is not a reason to skip.
D	Camouflage	The tetanus detail does not answer the zoster question.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A 44-year-old nonsmoker ~~who teaches high school chemistry~~ has an LDL of 205 mg/dL. His blood pressure is normal and ~~he plays tennis weekly~~. What is the best management?

Target word: statin decision **Decides:** LDL $\geq$ 190.

A	Adjacent category	Undertreats severe hypercholesterolemia.
B	Dropped element	Risk calculation is not needed at LDL $\geq$ 190.
C	Correct	LDL $\geq$ 190 calls for high-intensity therapy without a risk score.
D	Camouflage	Exercise does not remove the indication.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Blood pressure categories	Per 2017 ACC/AHA: normal < 120/< 80; elevated 120–129/< 80; stage 1 130–139 or 80–89; stage 2 ≥ 140 or ≥ 90 ; the higher category of the two numbers wins.	Using the older 140/90 cutoff for any hypertension, or classifying by systolic alone.	Averaged office readings to classify.
2	Diabetes diagnostic thresholds	Diabetes: A1C $\geq 6.5\%$, fasting glucose ≥ 126 mg/dL, 2-hour OGTT ≥ 200 , or random ≥ 200 with classic symptoms; without symptoms, confirm with two abnormal results. Prediabetes: A1C 5.7–6.4% or fasting 100–125.	Diagnosing from one borderline value, or missing the prediabetes range.	A1C or glucose values near a cutoff.
3	Comorbidity-driven diabetes therapy	In type 2 diabetes with established cardiovascular disease, heart failure, or chronic kidney disease, add an SGLT2 inhibitor or GLP-1 receptor agonist with proven benefit regardless of A1C.	Choosing the next drug by A1C lowering alone.	A patient with type 2 diabetes plus heart or kidney disease.
4	Colorectal cancer screening age	For average-risk adults, USPSTF recommends screening from 45 to 75; 76–85 is an individual decision; generally not after 85.	Starting screening at 50 or continuing routinely past 75.	An average-risk adult's age.
5	Motivational interviewing	Draw out the patient's own reasons for change with open questions and reflections; avoid lecturing or arguing, which builds resistance.	Telling the patient what to do more forcefully.	An ambivalent patient.
6	Acute low back pain imaging	Acute nonspecific low back pain without red flags does not need imaging; manage conservatively and encourage activity. Red flags (such as new bladder dysfunction or saddle anesthesia) need urgent evaluation.	Ordering an MRI for every back pain to reassure the patient.	Back pain with or without neurologic or systemic red flags.
7	Adult immunization basics	Recombinant zoster vaccine is two doses for adults 50 and older, even after prior shingles; Td or Tdap boosters every 10 years.	Skipping zoster vaccine because of past shingles.	An older adult's vaccine history.
8	Statin indications	LDL ≥ 190 mg/dL calls for high-intensity statin therapy without needing a risk calculation; adults 40–75 with diabetes need at least moderate-intensity therapy.	Waiting for a 10-year risk score when LDL is already ≥ 190 .	An LDL value at or above 190 or a patient with diabetes aged 40–75.

Course scope (public description): Adult Primary Care for the Advanced Practice Nurse prepares the graduate nursing student to perform the role of an advanced practice nurse with the essential competencies and skills necessary to provide primary healthcare to adult patients and families. This course will prepare the graduate nursing student to demonstrate competence in leading health promotion and disease prevention activities; diagnosing, managing, and coordinating care for patients with acute and chronic conditions; and empowering patients to pursue positive health outcomes. This course will also prepare the graduate nursing student to collaborate with adult patients to develop effective plans of care that build patient self-efficacy in the process of preventing and treating disease. There are no prerequisites for this course.